Echo

Ad-supported podcast app

THE BOARD'S QUESTION

Should Echo roll out aggressive push notifications to everyone?

DATA PERIOD	DATA FILES	ROWS IN TOTAL	GROUPS
Jan 2025 → Jun 2026	**3 CSV files**	**355,325**	**6, 12, 18**

The company

Business model. Free podcast & audio app, financed by audio ads. Echo earns about **€9 per 1,000 ad impressions (CPM)**. Users follow shows; the app sends push notifications about new episodes.

Situation. Between **15 January and 15 March 2026**, new users were randomly split into an A/B test: *control* (normal notifications) vs. *aggressive_push* (≈5 notifications a day with "Don't miss out!" copy). The growth team wants to roll out the aggressive version to everyone because "sessions are up 30 %".

Data period

January 2025 → June 2026 (18 months). The data was extracted on **30 June 2026**: anything after that date is not observed yet, so an empty end date means *still active at extraction*.

All amounts are in euros. All companies and data are fictional.

Data files

`users.csv` 20,909 rows

Column	Description
`user_id`	unique user
`signup_date`	account creation
`acquisition_channel`	paid_social / organic_store / podcast_cross_promo
`platform`	iOS / Android
`age_bucket`	18-24 / 25-34 / 35-44 / 45+
`push_variant`	standard (not in test) / control / aggressive_push
`shows_followed_week1`	number of shows followed in the first week

`weekly_activity.csv` 334,399 rows

Column	Description
`user_id`	user
`week_start`	Monday of the week (only weeks with activity)
`sessions`	app opens

Column	Description
`listening_minutes`	minutes listened
`ad_impressions`	ads heard
`push_notifications_received`	notifications sent

`marketing_spend.csv` 17 rows

Column	Description
`month`	first day of month
`channel`	channel
`spend_eur`	spend

Data quality

> **THIS IS A RAW EXTRACT**
>
> The files come straight from production systems and **have not been cleaned**. Expect what real data contains: duplicates, internal or test accounts, inconsistent labels, mixed date formats, impossible values, missing values and gaps.
>
> Write down every cleaning rule you apply and how many rows it affects: **your cleaning log is graded.**

Guiding questions

The same five questions apply to every company. They are starting points, not a checklist: the best projects find what is not asked here.

1. Map the funnel and, if there is one, the growth loop. Where does value leak?
2. Which channels, segments, cities or periods behave differently? Does the difference survive once you compare like with like?
3. What are the unit economics: CAC, retention, LTV, payback, by cohort and by channel?
4. What changed during these 18 months, and what did each change cause?
5. Which North Star Metric would you give this company, and why?

What you hand in

A **growth model** with a backtest and 3 scenarios, a **4-page report** with an A/B test plan and your cleaning log, and **10 slides** for an 8-minute defense followed by a cold question. All details and the grading grid are in the project brief.